Module 6 · Workbook answers

Practical application

Video: 39 min **Answer sheet**

In this final module everything comes together: your values, your identity, your goal, the 30-day method of change and the Seven Trees of Balance. You will see how the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ shows us, in practice, how to live all of it, and you will leave with a clear plan of action for your own life.

Answer sheet: the answers are in red. The reflection questions are personal, so your own answers will be in your own words and from your own life. These model answers show what the session teaches, to guide and check your thinking.

Key teachings

1. **The complete mission statement**

   Last time our mission statement was La ilaha illallah: remove every false god from the heart and put Allah alone in its place. The second half is how we put it into practice: Muhammadur Rasulullah, Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah. Allah is transcendent, beyond anything we can picture, so He sent a human being like us whom we can copy, follow and look up to. La ilaha illallah Muhammadur Rasulullah is our complete mission statement.

2. **The Prophet ﷺ: the closest reflection of the divine attributes**

   Allah is Al-Haqq (the Truth), and the Prophet ﷺ was known as as-Sadiq (the truthful) and al-Amin (the trustworthy) even before his prophethood. Allah is infinitely merciful, and He sent the Prophet ﷺ as a mercy to the worlds. Allah is Al-Wakil (the One we trust), and when the Prophet ﷺ migrated to Madinah he left Sayyiduna Ali behind to return the belongings people had entrusted to him, even though some of those people were trying to kill him. More than any other creation he reflected the attributes Allah loves, which is why he is the beloved of Allah and the master of the children of Adam, without boasting.

3. **Through the Sunnah we become khalifahs**

   Sunnah means the way of the Prophet ﷺ. By copying it we become the righteous khalifahs (people entrusted with the earth) that Allah announced to the angels. It works in every trust: with the body we speak the truth and keep our promises; with the mind we think well of others and make du'a, because Allah is Al-Mujib (the One who answers); with the heart we are patient and thankful to our family and colleagues; with the nafs (the self and its desires) we desire good for others. Even our work can reflect Him: a teacher reflects Al-'Alim (the All-Knowing), a doctor Ash-Shafi (the Healer). Islam is not only in the masjid; it is in every moment. The Prophet ﷺ warned of a woman who entered the Fire for cruelty to a cat, and of a woman known for her prayer who harmed her neighbours.

4. **Makkah: transforming the individual**

   The life of the Prophet ﷺ follows the same path as this course. For thirteen years in Makkah the focus was the individual: the purpose of life and identity, then purifying the body, the mind, the heart (gratitude, sincerity, humility, love and patience) and the nafs, leaving the sins that were widespread. Think of the patience of the companions who were tortured and did not fight back. In the early years the call was made privately, and those first Muslims were truly transformed. Abu Bakr went out and invited people such as Uthman, Abd al-Rahman ibn Awf and Talhah, who became among the ten promised Paradise.

5 **Madinah: building a society on purified trusts**

In Madinah everything was built on that foundation. The spirit and purpose of life led to the masjid, a place to worship the Creator. The purified body is the basis for defence and security; armed people without purification become destructive. The purified mind leads to learning, while learning without enlightenment gives us weapons of mass destruction. The purified heart is the basis for just leadership, as the caliph Umar ibn Abd al-Aziz answered complaints by calling for more justice. The purified nafs is the basis for fair economics, because greed brings financial systems crashing down. Your personal transformation is the start of a global one: every movement in history began with transformed individuals.

6 **The map of your journey**

Before you set out, you need a base camp of four things: aqidah (correct belief in One God), fiqh (the rules of how to pray, fast and so on; if you have not learnt these, find a class), tawbah (repentance, because you will always make mistakes) and mujahadah (striving, because it will be a struggle, not plain sailing). Then you cross the bridge: purifying the body, mind, heart and nafs. Some things are not objectives. A good dream is a good sign, and visions or even miracles may happen (Maryam was given miracles but was not a prophet), yet none of these is the goal. Feelings are not a measure either: you may not feel like praying, but you pray anyway. This path is not about making you feel good.

7 **The ultimate goal and four signs of progress**

The ultimate goal is the pleasure (rida) and grace (fadl) of Allah: in Paradise He will announce that He is pleased with its people and will never be displeased with them again. To check whether you are moving towards it, look for four signs. First, you always give preference to Allah's commands and to the Sunnah. Second, you have more compassion for people and for all of creation. Third, you take ownership of your actions instead of blaming others; when people say "you've changed", something has clicked. Fourth, you feel the presence of Allah (huḍūr), rather than praying while feeling something is missing.

8 **This is the beginning, not the end**

You now know who you are (a spirit with four trusts, not your nationality or job), why creation is there (to reveal who you truly are) and your purpose (to reflect the divine attributes by following the Prophet ﷺ). Time is short, so do not wait. Your ultimate homework is 30 days of waking up each morning thinking about tazkiyah (purification and beautification of the self). A mentor helps you go further, and you can aim higher still: many come to the Prophet ﷺ as a customer, wanting something for themselves; aim to be a shareholder in his work by helping others. Set a time frame, as you would for a degree, knowing tazkiyah continues for life.

From the Qur'an, the Sunnah and the scholars

يَٰٓأَيُّهَا ٱلنَّبِيُّ إِنَّآ أَرۡسَلۡنَٰكَ شَٰهِدٗا وَمُبَشِّرٗا وَنَذِيرٗا ۝ وَدَاعِيًا إِلَى ٱللَّهِ بِإِذۡنِهِۦ وَسِرَاجٗا مُّنِيرٗا

O Prophet, indeed We have sent you as a witness and a bringer of good tidings and a warner, and one who invites to Allāh, by His permission, and an illuminating lamp.

Surah Al-Ahzab 33:45–46

وَمَآ أَرۡسَلۡنَٰكَ إِلَّا رَحۡمَةٗ لِّلۡعَٰلَمِينَ

And We have not sent you, [O Muḥammad], except as a mercy to the worlds.

Surah Al-Anbiya 21:107

وَإِذْ قَالَ رَبُّكَ لِلْمَلَٰٓئِكَةِ إِنِّى جَاعِلٌ فِى ٱلْأَرْضِ خَلِيفَةً

And [mention, O Muḥammad], when your Lord said to the angels, "Indeed, I will make upon the earth a successive authority."

Surah Al-Baqarah 2:30

I am Muhammad, and I am Ahmad, and I am al-Mahi (the one through whom Allah erases disbelief), and I am al-Hashir (the one at whose feet people will be gathered), and I am al-'Aqib (the last, after whom there is no prophet).

Sahih al-Bukhari and Sahih Muslim

Allah will say to the people of Paradise, "Shall I not give you something better than all this?" They will say, "O our Lord, what could be better than this?" He will say, "I grant you My pleasure, and I will never be displeased with you after it."

Sahih al-Bukhari and Sahih Muslim

Practical exercises

My life plan: bringing the six modules together

1. Values (Module 1): name three of Allah's attributes you most want to reflect, and next to each, how the Prophet ﷺ lived it.
2. Identity (Module 2): for each trust (body, mind, heart, nafs), write one thing to purify and one thing to beautify.
3. Goal (Module 3): write your goal in one line, for example "To become a friend of Allah by...", and give it a time frame of one, two or three years.
4. Change (Module 4): choose the one habit you will install first through 30 days, and write your start date.
5. Balance (Module 5): name the tree of balance you will water alongside it, and the small step you will take.
6. Write La ilaha illallah Muhammadur Rasulullah at the top of your plan as your mission statement, then sign and date it.

Following the Sunnah in each of my trusts

1. Choose one area: body, mind, heart, nafs, or your work or role at home.
2. Write an attribute of Allah that fits it (for example Al-Haqq, Al-Mujib, Ash-Shakur, Al-'Alim).
3. Write how the Prophet ﷺ reflected it (for example, he was as-Sadiq and al-Amin).
4. Write one specific way you will reflect it this week, and who will benefit (your spouse, children, parents, colleagues, neighbours).

Base camp check and signs of progress

1. Tick the parts of your base camp that feel secure: aqidah ☐ fiqh ☐ tawbah ☐ mujahadah ☐. Write how you will strengthen the weakest one.
2. Score each sign of progress from 1 to 10: preference for Allah's commands and the Sunnah ___ compassion for creation ___ taking ownership ___ presence with Allah ___
3. Think of a time you judged your progress by a feeling, a dream or a lack of one. Write what the four signs say instead.

My first 14 days of tazkiyah

Tick each day you practise.

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14
Woke up thinking about tazkiyah														
Kept my 30-day habit														
Followed one Sunnah with intention														
Made tawbah and du'a														

Reflection questions and answers

1. Now that you understand Muhammadur Rasulullah as the practical side of La ilaha illallah, how does it change the way you see your love for the Prophet ﷺ?

> Allah is transcendent, beyond anything we can picture, so He sent a human being like us whom we can copy, follow and look up to; La ilaha illallah Muhammadur Rasulullah is our complete mission statement. Love for the Prophet ﷺ then becomes more than a feeling: following his Sunnah is how we reflect the attributes Allah loves. For example: I now see following his manners at home as part of my mission, not an optional extra.

2. Which attribute that the Prophet ﷺ reflected (truthfulness, mercy, trustworthiness, patience, gratitude) do you most need in your life right now, and where?

> The Prophet ﷺ was the closest reflection of the divine attributes: known as as-Sadiq and al-Amin (the truthful and the trustworthy) before prophethood, sent as a mercy to the worlds, and so trustworthy that on the Hijrah he left Sayyiduna Ali behind to return people's belongings, even to those trying to kill him. A good answer names one quality and a specific place it is needed. For example: I most need patience with my teenage son, especially in the mornings before school.

3. In your work or your role at home, which attribute of Allah can you reflect, and what would that look like on an ordinary day?

> Islam is not only in the masjid; every role can reflect one of Allah's attributes. A teacher reflects Al-'Alim (the All-Knowing) and a doctor Ash-Shafi (the Healer), while with the mind we think well of others and make du'a to Al-Mujib (the One who answers). For example: as a mother I can reflect Allah's mercy by speaking gently when the children are tired, and at work I can reflect Al-Haqq (the Truth) by being honest in every report.

4. Which part of your base camp (belief, rules, repentance, striving) is weakest, and what is the next step to strengthen it?

> The base camp has four parts: aqidah (correct belief in One God), fiqh (the rules of how to pray, fast and so on), tawbah (repentance, because we will always make mistakes) and mujahadah (striving, because the path is a struggle, not plain sailing). Name the weakest honestly and give one practical next step. For example: my fiqh is weakest because I was never properly taught how to pray, so my next step is to find a class and enrol this month.

5. When have you let a feeling decide whether you were doing well spiritually? What would the four signs of progress have told you?

> Feelings, good dreams and even visions are not the goal or the measure: you may not feel like praying, but you pray anyway. Instead, look at the four signs of progress: giving preference to Allah's commands and the Sunnah, more compassion for creation, taking ownership instead of blaming others, and feeling the presence of Allah. For example: I thought I was failing because my prayers felt dry, yet the signs show I have become more compassionate and stopped blaming others for everything.

6. How could your own transformation ripple out to your family, community or workplace?

> The life of the Prophet ﷺ shows the pattern: thirteen years in Makkah transforming individuals, then a society in Madinah built on purified trusts, with the masjid, just leadership and fair economics. Every movement in history began with transformed individuals, so your personal change is the start of a wider one. For example: if I become more patient and truthful, my children will copy it, and at work my honesty could change how my team treats customers.

7. Who could you travel this path with, and how could you one day help someone else on it?

> A mentor and good company help you go further, and the session invites us to aim higher than being a "customer" of the Prophet ﷺ, wanting something for ourselves, and to become a "shareholder" in his work by helping others. Abu Bakr showed this when he invited people such as Uthman, Abd al-Rahman ibn Awf and Talhah. For example: I could do my 30 days alongside my sister, and one day share what I have learnt with the young people at my mosque.

My action plan

- [ ] I will complete my life plan this week and keep it where I will see it every day.
- [ ] I will start my 30 days, waking up each morning thinking about tazkiyah.
- [ ] I will choose one Sunnah to follow with intention, reflecting one of Allah's attributes in my family or my work.
- [ ] I will check my progress by the four signs, not by my feelings.
- [ ] I will seek good company or a mentor for this journey, and aim one day to help others on it.
- [ ] I will sit the course exam to consolidate everything I have learnt across the six modules.